Sechindra Vallury

Odum School of Ecology, University of Georgia
sechindra.vallury@uga.edu www.sechindravallury.com

Education

2014-2019	School of Sustainability, Arizona State University, AZ. Ph.D., Sustainability. Advisors: Drs. Joshua K Abbott & John M Anderies.
2012-2014	Department of Natural Resources, TERI School of Advanced Studies, India. M.S., Environmental Studies and Resource Management.
2006-2010	Department of Mechanical Engineering, Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, India. B.S., Mechanical Engineering.

Professional Experience

08/22-	Assistant Professor of Environmental Policy, Odum School of Ecology Director of Policy, River Basin Center, University of Georgia, GA.
02/20-07/22	Postdoctoral Associate, WA Franke College of Forestry & Conservation, University of Montana, MT.
09/19-02/20	Postdoctoral Associate, Nicholas School of the Environment, Duke University, NC.

Research Activities

Equal authorship is indicated by a *. Publications with students or postdocs are indicated with a †. Impact Factors (IF) from the 2025 Clarivate Journal Citation Reports.

Since Tenure-Track Appointment

21. Sarr, M., Mensah, E., & **Vallury, S.** (2026). Rethinking Resilience: Lessons from Climate-Smart Innovation in African Agriculture. *Journal of Development Perspectives*, 6(1-2), 1-7. Penn State University Press. *Invited editorial.*

20. **Vallury, S.**, Nelson, D. R., and Cook, N.J. (2025). "Rethinking adaptation interventions in agricultural systems for sustainability." *Current Opinion in Environmental Sustainability*, 77, 101571. *IF: 8.6. Invited review.*

19. Benedum, M.E.†, Cook, N.J., and **Vallury, S.** (2025)."Out-Migration and Participation in Community-Based Natural Resource Management: The Role of Remittances." *Ecology & Society*, 30(3). *IF: 4.0.*

18. **Vallury, S.**, Cook, N.J., and Nelson, D. (2024). "Social inequalities shape climate change adaptation in Indian farmers." *Environmental Research Letters*, 19(11), 114035. *IF: 5.4.*

17. Olivier, T.* and **Vallury, S.*** (2024). "Institutional Fit and Policy Design in Water Governance: Nebraska's Natural Resources Districts." *Policy Studies Journal*, 52(4), 809-832. *IF: 4.2. Scopus Rank in Public Administration: 2/242.*

16. Nesbitt, H., Metcalf, A., Floyd, T., Uden, D., Chaffin, B., Gulab, S., Banerjee, S., **Vallury, S.**, Hamlin, S., Metcalf, E., Fogarty, D., Twidwell, D., and Allen, C. (2024). "Social networks and transformative behaviors in a grassland social-ecological system." *People & Nature*, 6(5), 1877-1892. *IF: 5.8. Scopus Rank in Biodiversity Conservation: 5/77.*

15. Smith, A.P.†, **Vallury, S.**, and Metcalf, E.C. (2023). "Social dimensions of adaptation in rangeland social-ecological systems: A systematic literature review." *Climatic Change*, 176, 180. *IF: 5.2.*

14. **Vallury, S.**, Chaffin, B. C., Hamlin, S. L., and Allen, C. R. (2023). "Communication in the science-policy interface: Evidence from a boundary organization in Nebraska, USA." *Environmental Science & Policy*, 148, 103558. *IF: 5.5*

13. Shin, H.C.†, Yousefi, P.†, Park, S.†, Yu, D.J., Janssen, M., **Vallury, S.**, and Araral, E. (2023). "Coping with Unreliable Water Supply: An Experimental Study of Exit and Voice." *Water Resources Research*, 59, e2022WR032468. *IF: 6.3.*

12. Breetz, H.L., Stokes, L.C.*, **Vallury, S.**, and Cuiffo, K.V. (2022). "City Pledges for 100% Renewable Energy: A Matched Pair Analysis of Policy Adoption." *Energy Research & Social Science*, 90, 102664. *IF: 7.2.*

11. Shin, H.C.†, **Vallury, S.**, Janssen, M.A., and Yu, D.J. (2022). "Joint effects of voluntary participation and group selection on the evolution of altruistic punishment." *PLoS One*, 17(5), e0268019. *IF: 2.8.*

10. **Vallury, S.**, Smith, A.P., Chaffin, B.C., Nesbitt, H.K., Lohani, S., Gulab, S., Banerjee, S., Floyd, T.M., Metcalf, A.L., Metcalf, E.C., Twidwell, D., Uden, D.R., Williamson, M.A., and Allen, C.R. (2022). "Beyond the household: a literature review of scale and aggregation in adaptive capacity research". *Environmental Research Letters*, 17, 063001. *IF: 5.4.*

9. **Vallury, S.**, H. C. Shin, M. A. Janssen, R. Meinzen-Dick, S. Kandikuppa, K. R. Rao, and R. Chaturvedi. (2022). "Assessing the institutional foundations of adaptive water governance in South India". *Ecology and Society*, 27(1):18. *IF: 4.0.*

8. Shin, H.C., **Vallury, S.**, Abbott, J.K., Anderies, J.M., and Yu, D. (2022). "Understanding the role of competitive and participatory institutions in sustainable governance of irrigation systems". *Ecological Economics*, 191, 107221. *IF: 6.7.*

7. **Vallury, S.** and Leonard, B.J. (2022)."Canals, Climate, and Corruption: The Provisioning of Public Infrastructure under Uncertainty". *Economics & Politics*, 34, 221-252. *IF: 2.2.*

Prior to Tenure-Track Appointment

5. **Vallury, S.**, Abbott, J. K., Shin, H. C., and Anderies, J. M. (2020). "Sustaining Coupled Irrigation Infrastructures: Multiple Instruments for Multiple Dilemmas." *Ecological Economics*, 178, 106793.

4. Mueller, V., Masias, I.*, and **Vallury, S.*** (2019). "Labor-Saving Technologies and Structural Transformation in Northern Ghana." *Agricultural Economics*, 50(5), 581-594.

3. Janssen, M., Anderies, J.M., Baeza, A., Breetz, H.L., Jasinski, T., Shin, H.C., and **Vallury, S.** (2019). "Highways as coupled infrastructure systems: an integrated approach to address sustainability challenges." *Sustainable and Resilient Infrastructure*, 1-12.

2. Baggio, J.A., Schoon, M., and **Valury, S.** (2019). "Managing networked landscapes: conservation in a fragmented, connected world." *Regional Environmental Change*, 19(8), 2551-2562.

1. Bernstein, M.J., Mancha-Cisneros, M., Tyson, M., Brady, U.*, Shin, H.C.*, **Vallury, S.***, Smith-Heisters, S., Ratajczyk, E. (2019). "Mapping Ostrom's Common-pool Resource Systems Coding Handbook to the Coupled Infrastructure Systems Framework to Enable Comparative Research." *International Journal of the Commons*, 13(1), 528-52.

Manuscripts in Review

Vallury, S., Cook, N.J., Nelson, D., and Rao, S. "Who Migrates? Social Identity and the Limits of Climate Adaptation." *Conditional Acceptance at Earth's Future.*

Hallmark, M.†, **Vallury, S.**, Thompson, J., and George, A. "Information and Conservation Adoption in TN Agriculture". *Under review at Society & Natural Resources. Lead author was my M.S. student.*

Zhang, F., **Vallury, S.**, and Cook, N.J. "The Limits of Scaling Justice in U.S. Climate Adaptation Plans." *Under revision at Global Environmental Change.*

Vallury, S., Nelson, D., and Albrecht, T.R. "Assessment Scale Shapes the Visibility of Climate Vulnerability." *Under revision at Communications Earth & Environment.*

Vallury, S., Watkins, B., Marty, E., Burke, B.J., Welch-Devine, M., Sourdril, A., and Thompson, J.J. "Anticipating Policy Futures for Pastoral Systems Through a Multi-Level Delphi Approach." *Under review at Environmental Science & Policy.*

Yan, X.†, **Vallury, S.**, Rasquinha, D.N., and Mishra, D.R. "How do scientific research and market mechanisms shape the spatio-temporal evolution of global blue carbon policy?" *Under review at Environmental Science & Policy. Developed from the lead author's term paper in my policy course.*

Vallury, S., Cook, N.J. and Dubash, N. "Development Without Local Resilience: Rural Roads and Drought in India." *Under review at World Development.*

Vallury, S., Wenger, S., and Dubash, N. "Droughts Increase Inequality through Uneven Recovery." *Submitted to Science.*

Teaching Activities

Courses Taught

- Ecological Basis of Environmental Issues (Spring 2025)
- Agent-Based Modeling (Fall 2023, 2025)
- Environmental Policy & Natural Resource Management (Fall 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026)
- Perspectives on Integrative Conservation & Sustainability (Fall 2024, 2025, 2026)
- Water Policy Seminar (Spring 2023)

Research Grants

Funded Grants

2024-2027	NSF Human-Environment and Geographical Sciences Program. "Equitable pathways to climate-smart agriculture: Rethinking adaptation as a continuum." (PI, $400,000).
2024-2025	US Department of Interior. "2025 Biennial Georgia Water Resources Conference" (PI, $25,000).
2024-2026	US Department of Army ERDC. "Expanding Research Test Beds for Nature-based Solutions in the Southeastern U.S." (Co-PI, $4,267,933).
2024-2027	Belmont Forum. "Mitigation and adaptation in cultural heritage landscapes: Lessons from transhumant pastoral systems for managing novel climate risks." (Co-PI, $399,906). *Administered by NSF.*
2023-2024	NSF CRISES Program. "Planning Proposal: Collaborative Research and Education Center for Transformative Water Solutions." (Co-PI, $100,000).
2023-2024	UGA E-Mobility Initiative Seed Proposal Program (PI, $66,000).
2023-2024	UGA Teaming for Interdisciplinary Research Pre-Seed Grant (PI, $4,000).

2018-2019 Graduate Dissertation Fellowship, Center for Study of Economic Liberty, Arizona State University, AZ. ($10,000).

2018-2019 Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies, ($5,000).

2016-2017 Neely Foundation Food & Agriculture Sustainability Research Grant, School of Sustainability, Arizona State University, AZ. ($4,000).

Grant Proposals & Fellowships Submitted

In Review NASA Accelerating Earth Solutions: "INFORM: Information Needs for Operational Farm Risk Management." (PI). *Total Award: $150,000. Submitted in October 2026.*

In Review Fulbright-U.S. Scholar Program: "RE-FARM: Energy Innovation and Farm-Level Energy Security in India." *Submitted in September 2026.*

Declined NSF Growing Convergence Research: "Scaling Adaptive Water Strategies for Resilient Agricultural Landscapes (SAWS)." (Co-PI, $3,599,298). *Submitted in February 2026.*

Declined USDA NIFA Foundational Program. "Farmers' Adoption Research and Choice Modeling of Agrivoltaics (FARM-AV)." (PI, $300,000). *Resubmitted in October 2025.*

Declined USDA NIFA Foundational Program. "Farmers' Adoption Research and Choice Modeling of Agrivoltaics (FARM-AV)." (PI, $300,000). *Submitted in September 2024. Recommended for funding; ultimately declined and encouraged to resubmit.*

Awards & Fellowships

2024 Hayek Research Award, The Institute for Humane Studies.

2023 UGA Teaching Academy Early Career Fellows Program.

2018 Adam Smith Fellowship, Mercatus Center, ($10,000).

2018 Graduate Dissertation Fellowship, Arizona State University.

Conference Participation & Invited Talks

- *(Invited)* "Who Recovers? The Political Economy of Climate Resilience in India." 2026 Climate Pipeline Project Workshop. Columbia University. New York City, USA. May 13-15, 2026.
- "Who Recovers? The Political Economy of Climate Resilience in India." 2026 Midwest Political Science Association Conference. Chicago, Illinois, USA. April 22-26, 2026.
- *(Invited)* "Governance for Sustainable Climate Adaptation: Lessons from the South Asia and the U.S." School of Environment & Natural Resources, The Ohio State University. Columbus, USA. February 19-20, 2026.
- "Does Information Drive Conservation Behavior? Evidence from a Field Experiment." Biennial Conference of the International Association for the Study of the Commons, Amherst, USA. June 16-20, 2025.
- "Access Inequalities in Electric Vehicle Infrastructure in the Southeast U.S.". Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference. Chicago, Illinois, USA. April 4-6, 2025.
- "Differentiated Effects of Climate Migration". National Sustainability Society Symposium. Seattle, Washington, USA. September 9-11, 2024.
- *(Invited)* "Institutions and Inequality in Climate Adaptation." Penn State School of International Affairs. State College, Pennsylvania, USA. February 1-3, 2024.

- "Social inequalities shape climate change adaptation among Indian farmers". 2023 Association of Public Policy Analysis & Management. Atlanta, Georgia, USA. November 9-11, 2023.
- "Institutional Fit and Policy Design in Water Governance: Nebraska's Natural Resources Districts". 2023 Association of Public Policy Analysis & Management. Atlanta, Georgia, USA. November 9-11, 2023.
- "Social inequalities shape climate change adaptation among Indian farmers". XIX Biennial IASC Conference, Nairobi. June 19-24, 2023.
- (*Invited*) Panel on "Natural Infrastructure and Equity". 2023 Georgia Water Resources Conference. Athens, Georgia, USA. March 30-31, 2023.
- "Assessing the institutional foundations of adaptive water governance in South India". 2022 Conference on Earth System Governance. Toronto, Canada. October 20-24, 2022.
- "Beyond the household: a literature review of scale and aggregation in adaptive capacity research". International Association for Society and Natural Resources Virtual Conference. 20-22 June, 2021.

Student Mentoring

Current Graduate Students

- Kaili Gregory, Committee Member, Ph.D. ICON, Warnell School of Forestry & Natural Resources.
- Monika Giri, Committee Member, Ph.D. ICON, Anthropology.

Past Graduate Students

- Mackenzie Hallmark, Advisor, M.S. Ecology Integrative Conservation and Sustainability. *Graduated Summer 2026.*
- Maria Ramsey, Committee Member, Ph.D., Department of Agricultural Leadership, Education, & Communication. *Graduated Spring 2026.*
- Niketa Nandan, Committee Member, M.S. Civil and Environmental Engineering. *Graduated Summer 2026.*
- Michaela Collins, Committee Member, M.S. Warnell School of Forestry & Natural Resources. *Graduated Summer 2026.*
- Jonathan Parrish, Advisor, M.S. Ecology Integrative Conservation and Sustainability. *Graduated Spring 2025.*
- Crystal Pendargast, Committee Member, M.S. Integrative Conservation and Sustainability. *Graduated Spring 2024.*
- Sabyasachi Kar, Committee Member, M.S. Warnell School of Forestry & Natural Resources. *Graduated Spring 2024.*
- Megan Seidel, Committee Member, MNR Warnell School of Forestry & Natural Resources. *Graduated Fall 2023.*

Undergraduate Students

Samantha Dilley, 2023 Spring CURO Research Award

Professional Service

- *Associate Editor*: Ecology & Society; Journal of Development Perspectives.

- *Ad-hoc grant reviewer*: National Science Foundation Human-Environment Geographical Systems; Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada.

Administration

- Program Chair, Biennial Georgia Water Resources Conference: 2025, 2027.
- Organizer, UGA Climate & Research Slam: 2024, 2026.
- Organizer, Confluence: UGA Water Science and Policy Poster Symposium: 2023-2026.

University Service

- 2024-2027 University Council
- 2026-2029 University HR Committee
- 2024-2027 Undergraduate Committee

Professional Memberships

- American Economic Association
- Midwest Political Science Association
- International Association for Society and Natural Resources
- International Association for the Study of the Commons